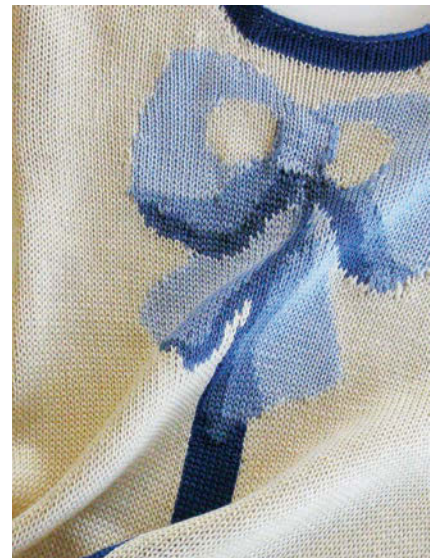
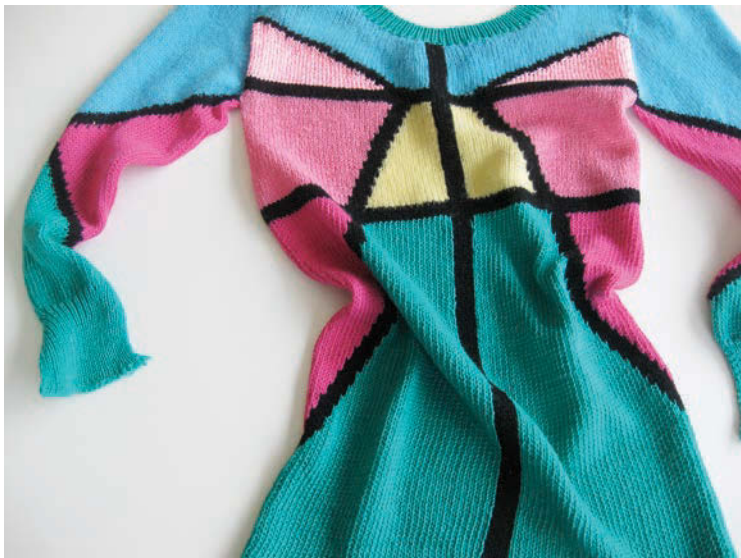
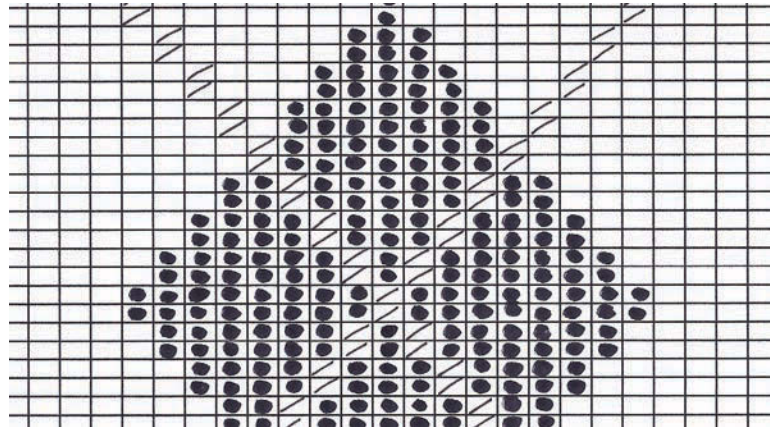
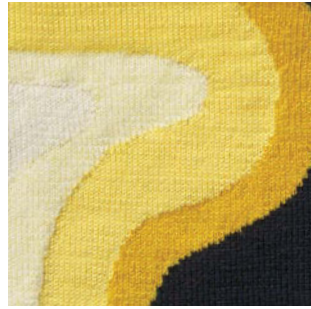


LEARN INVENTIVE INTARSIA



by
Sue Enticknap and Richard Dykes

Learn Intarsia



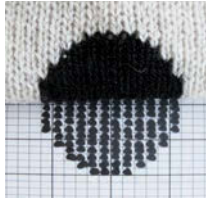
Contents



Getting started 5

Stripes 6

Graphing out shapes 8

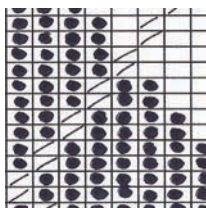


Curve & Circle 10



Argyle 12

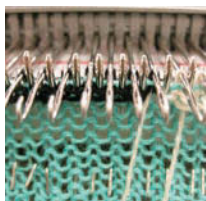
How to make an argyle 14



Novelty 16

LOVE Sweater - Machine knit 19

Hand knit 25





Floral 30

Hellebore 33

Leaves 34

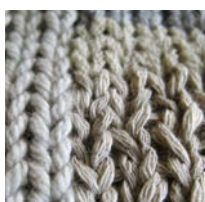


Abstract 36

70's Vibe 38

Paintbox 40

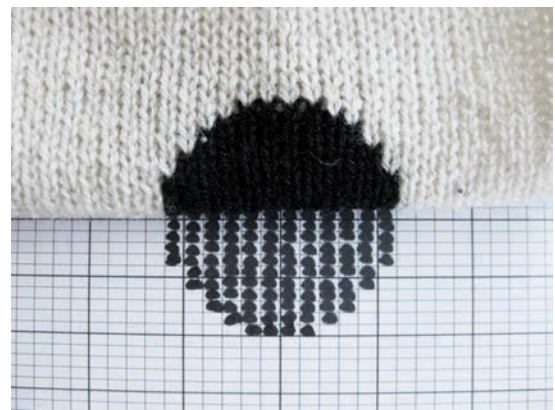
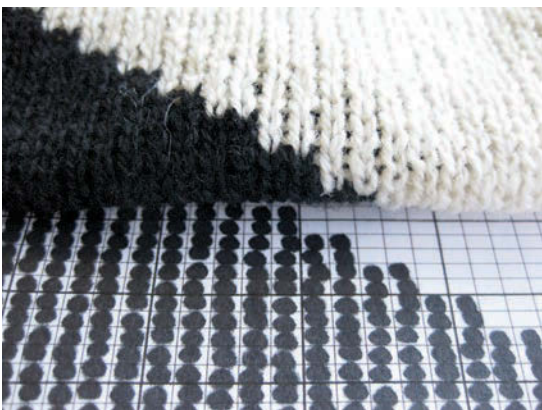
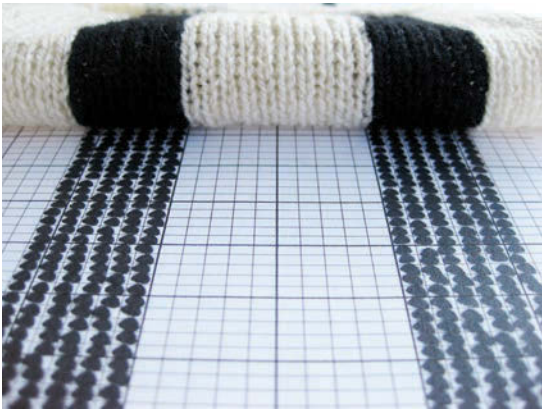
Colour blocks 42



Tone on Tone 44

Useful Information 47

Our Profile 48



Getting started



fig 1



fig 2

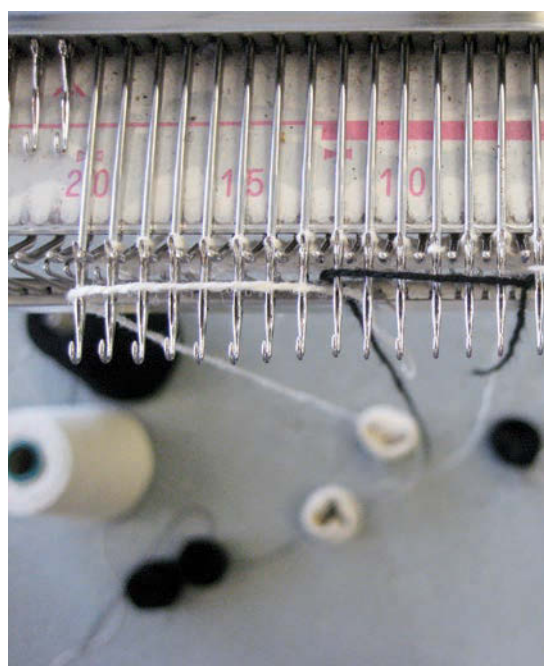


fig 3



Intarsia is a single jersey knit using multi-colours to create patterns without floats. Most knitting machines need a separate intarsia carriage to achieve these fabrics.

- The method for creating intarsias is to use the main carriage to cast on and hang the weights (fig 1)
- Take the main carriage off the bed completely
- Fit the intarsia carriage (fig 2) onto the bed and take it across the needles from left to right. This will bring the needles out to D position, with the latches all open (fig 3)
- The next stage is to decide on a pattern.



Vertical stripes

The easiest motif to start with is a vertical stripe. Decide which needles you want to knit in contrast.

- We have knitted 6sts in black and 10sts in ecru (fig 4)
- You need to make a little ball of each colour used, in each position. Use a ball winder and take the end from the centre (fig 5)



fig 4



fig 5

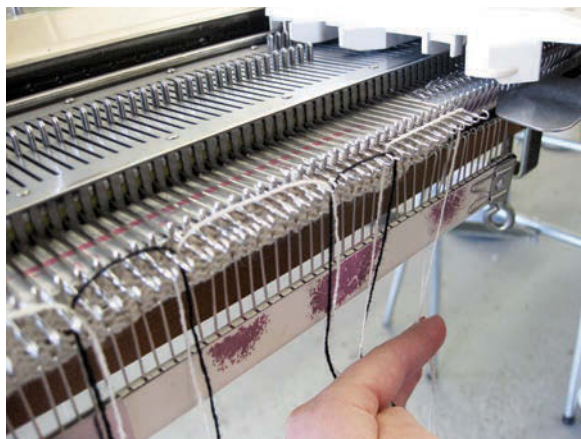


fig 6



fig 7

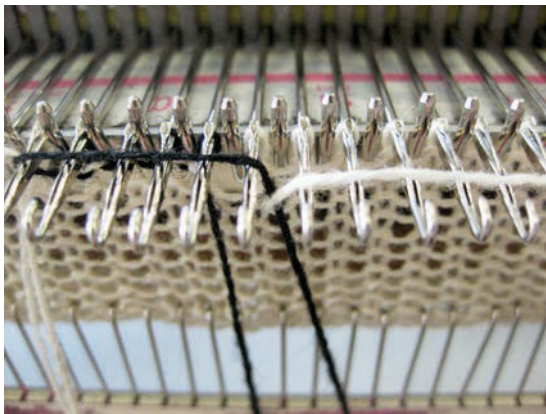


fig 8a



fig 8b

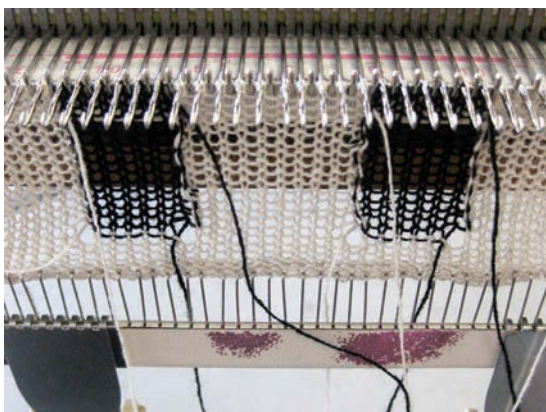


fig 9

- Lay the yarn across the needles with the end of the yarn on the same side as the intarsia carriage (to the right), and the ball of yarn to the left (fig 6)
- Lightly hold the yarn downward, in the latches of the needles, and at the same time bring intarsia carriage across from right to left
- The yarns will have knitted 1 row (fig 7)
- To knit the subsequent rows, lay the yarn over as you did for the first row (fig 8a-b) but twist the contrast yarns where they meet between the coloured sections. This is essential to 'join' the coloured sections together
- Repeat (fig 9).



Graphing out shapes

Almost any shape is possible using intarsia. However to create an accurate replica of the shape you want to translate it is essential to work on the correct size of graph paper.

The stiches and rows of knits do not form a true square grid but are usually 'squashed', having more rows than stitches in the same measurement

It is advisable to knit a tension swatch which is at least 10cm x 10cm.

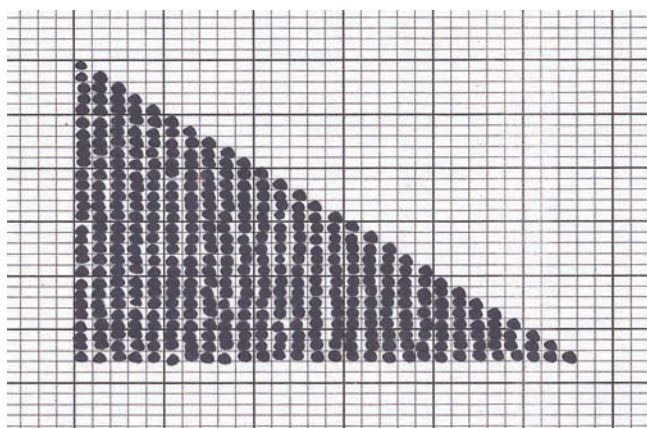


fig 10

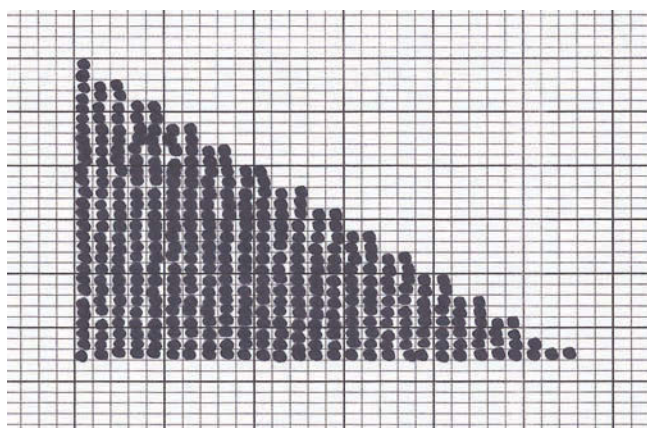
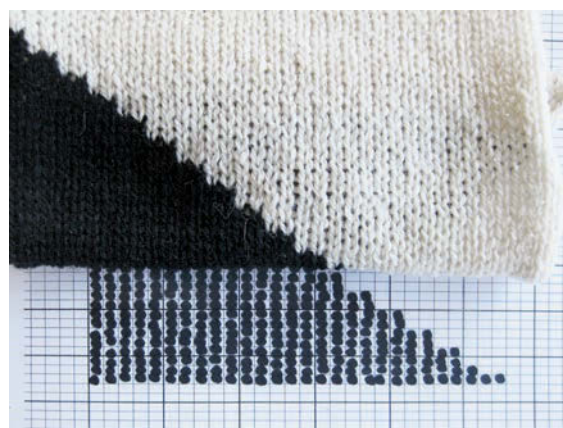


fig 11



- The tension we knitted in fig 10 was 3sts x 5r / 1 cm², we therefore created graph paper on the computer (or you can obtain from the internet), that exactly matched the size of the stitches and rows
- Fig 10 show the graph marked out and the subsequent knit exactly matching the size. This was following a shape of 1st ev 1r to create the angle
- Fig 11 shows the same angle but created using 'steps' of 2sts ev 2r

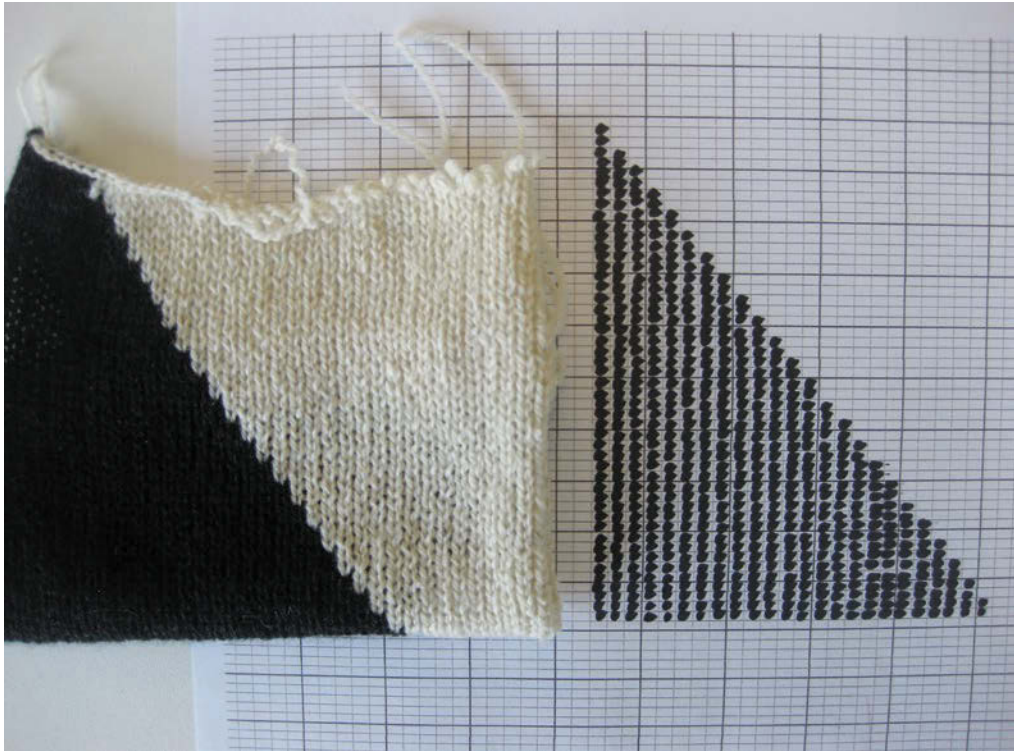


fig 12



fig 13

- Fig 12 shows an angle of 1st ev 2r
- Fig 13 is a 'random' positive/negative idea.

Curve & Circle

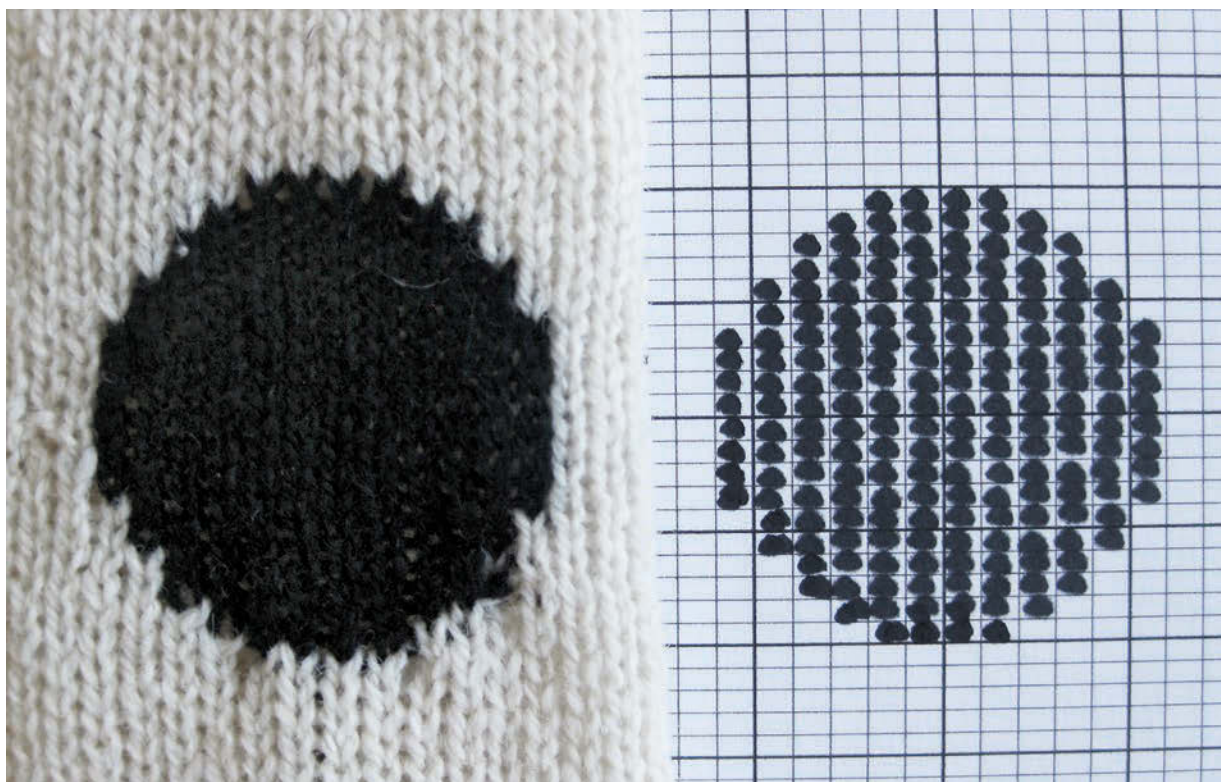


fig 14

Using the correct graph paper it is easy to interpret any curve exactly.

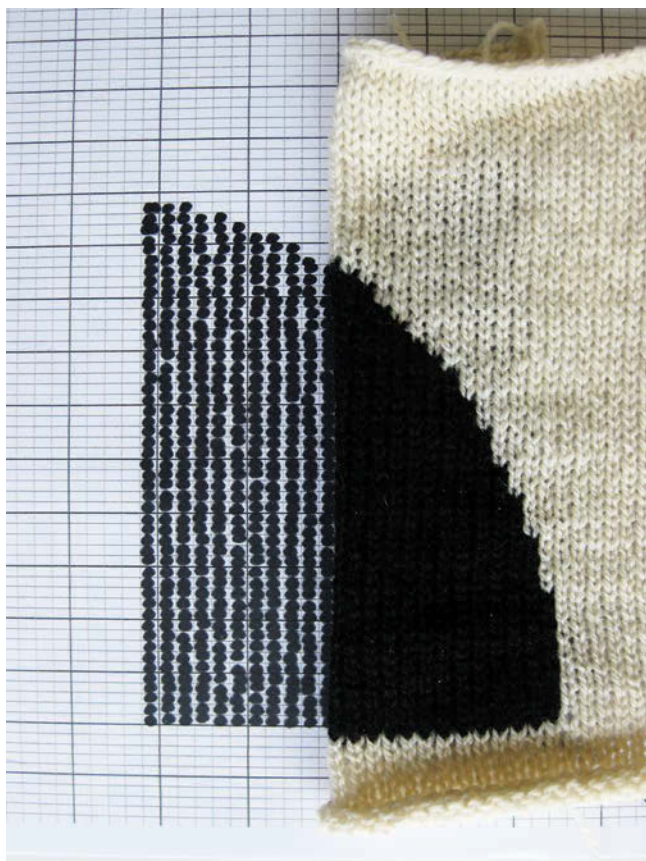


fig 15

- These circle (fig 14) and curve (fig 15) were marked out to exactly correspond to the resulting knit

- The circle in fig 16 has been marked out on a graph paper on which the squares have been too high in relation to the height of the row so the motif looks 'squashed'.

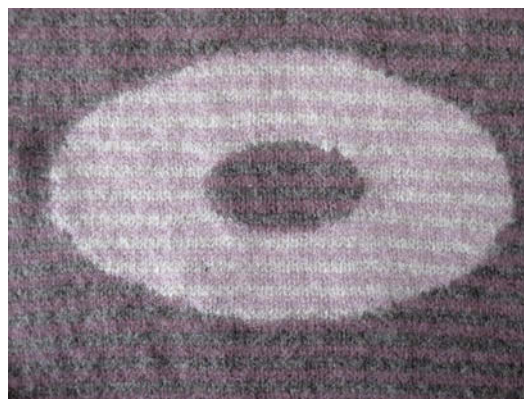
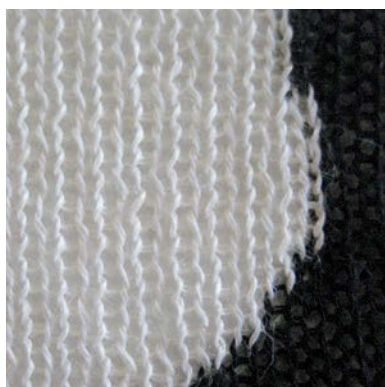
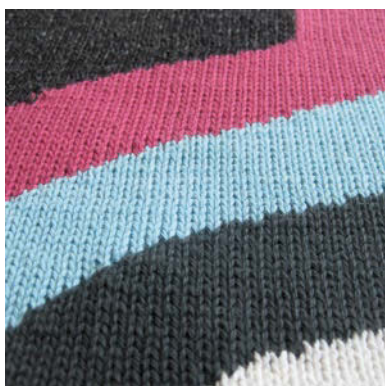


fig 16



Polkadot and curve inspiration from prints and knits.

Argyle

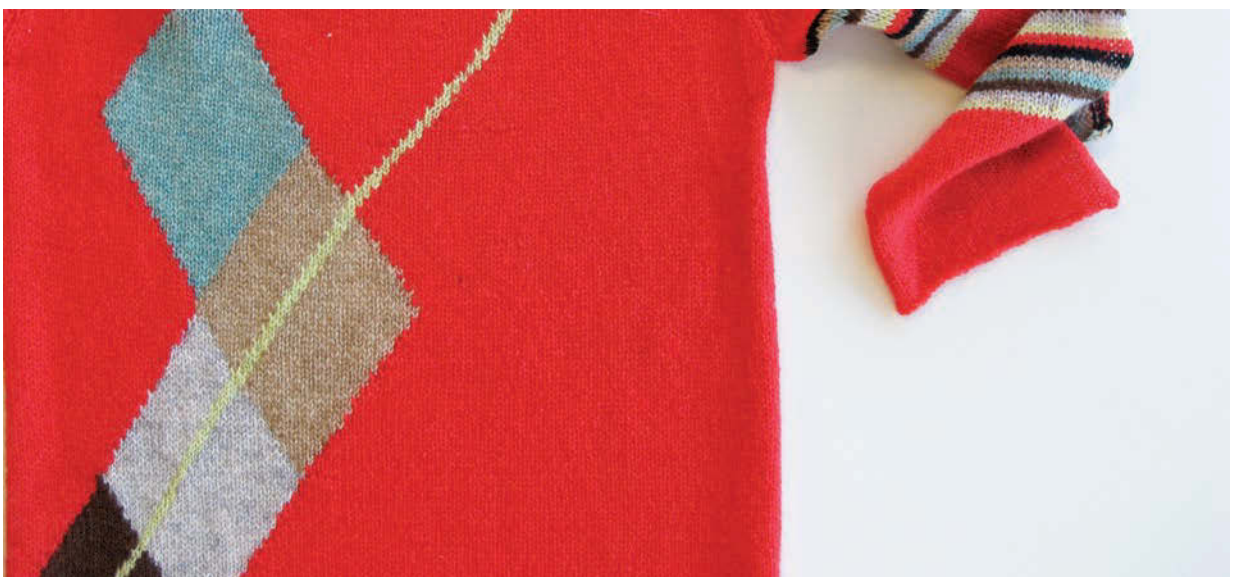


fig 17

Argyle is a traditional Scottish textile, originally made as 'tartan' knitted socks to be worn with a kilt. The pattern was first popularised by golfers who adopted the 'tartan' sock worn with plus fours. Argyle is now a popular fashion staple that has gone way beyond its sporting traditions.

- The traditional Argyle is an elongated diamond with narrow 'shakers' (contrast lines) that cross the main diamond (fig 17)





Numerous variations can be created from the traditional Argyle inspiration.

How to make an argyle



fig 18

We have created a traditional argyle shape using a chunky (3g) machine and tweed effect hand knit yarns (fig 18).

- We created a tension swatch and created graph paper to match
- Graph out the shape including a different mark to represent the 3rd colour of the shaker (fig 19)

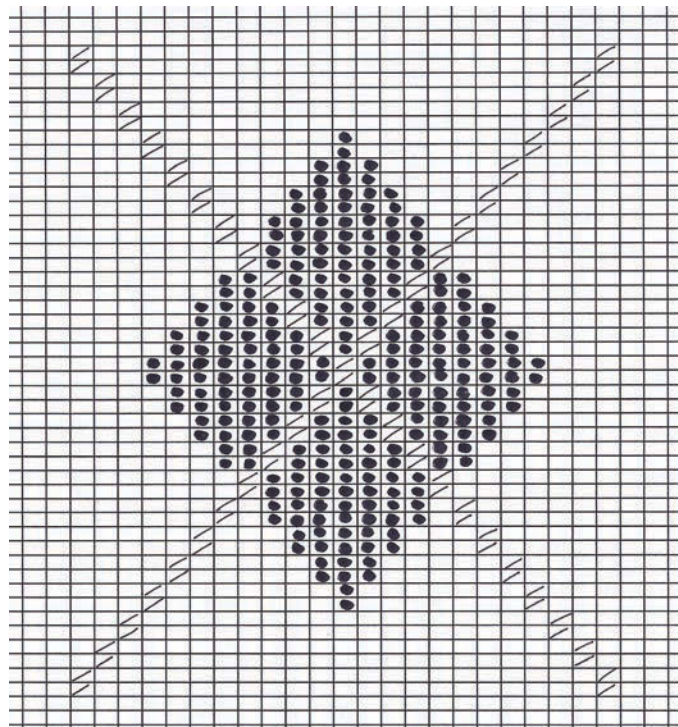


fig 19



fig 20



fig 21

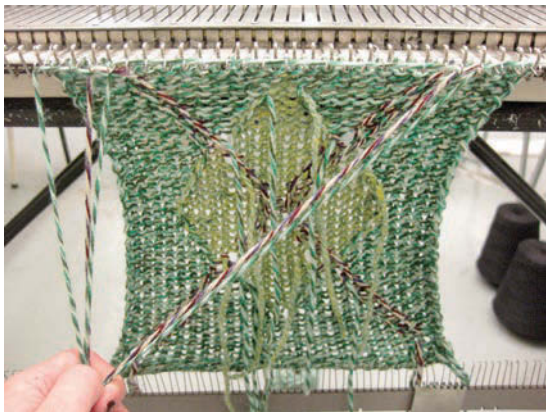


fig 22

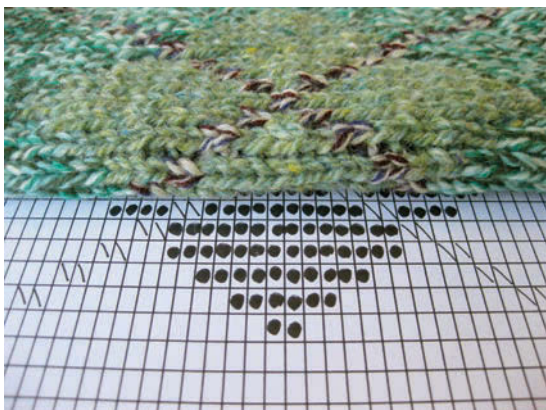


fig 23

- Follow instructions as written on pages 6-7
- Remember to create a ball of yarn for each section of knit
- Hold the yarn loosely as you take the intarsia carriage across (fig 20)
- Remember to twist the colour changes (fig 21)
- You can see pattern forming clearly from the back (fig 22)
- The finished piece should match the graph paper (fig 23).



Novelty



Intarsia is a great technique for novelty images. It is possible to knit any shape in intarsia, it is only limited by the knitter's patience!



Fig 24. Lisa Landsburgh "Bulldog"

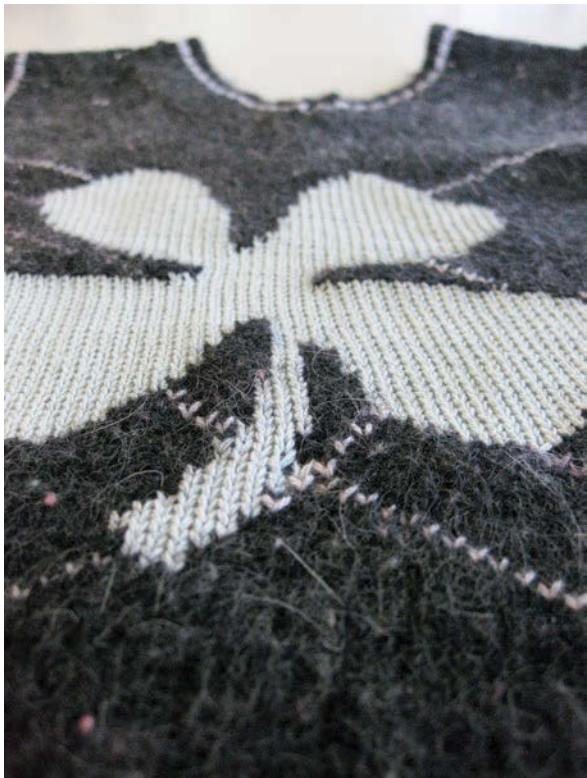


Fig 25. Lisa Landsburgh "Bulldog"

- 'Bulldog' design by Lisa Landsburgh (fig 24) and the reverse (dual) side of the design (fig 25).



Lisa Landsburgh 'Poodle'





LOVE sweater

Intarsia is a great way to knit writing. Here is an idea for a 'LOVE' sweater. The front bodice is intarsia with the back and sleeves in plain knit. All edges are e-wrap with no ribs. You can copy and enlarge this graph (fig 26) to follow yourself. The words are reversed to follow from the back side of the sweater front. We worked it in ecru lambswool with each letter in a different shade of grey lambswool.

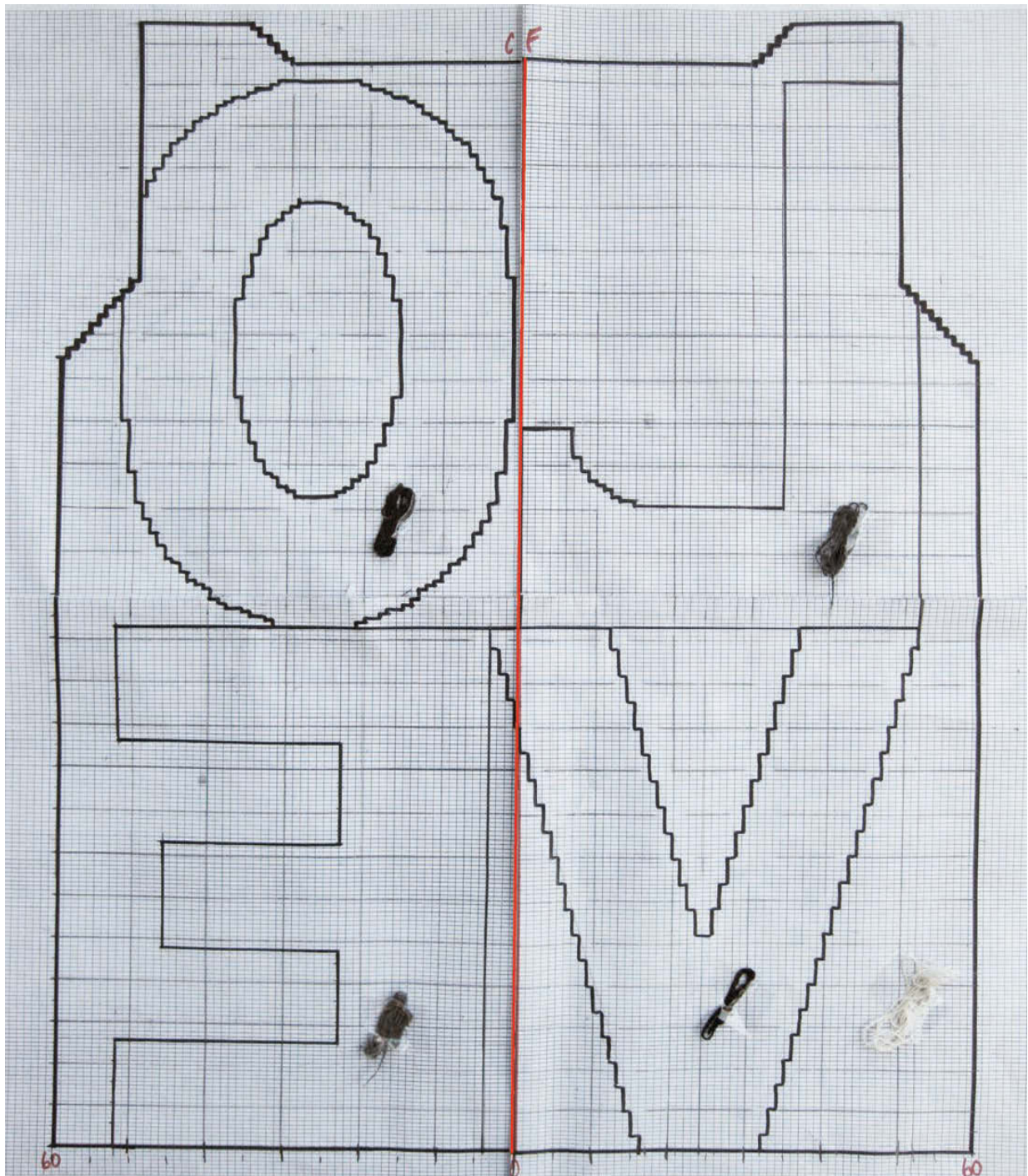
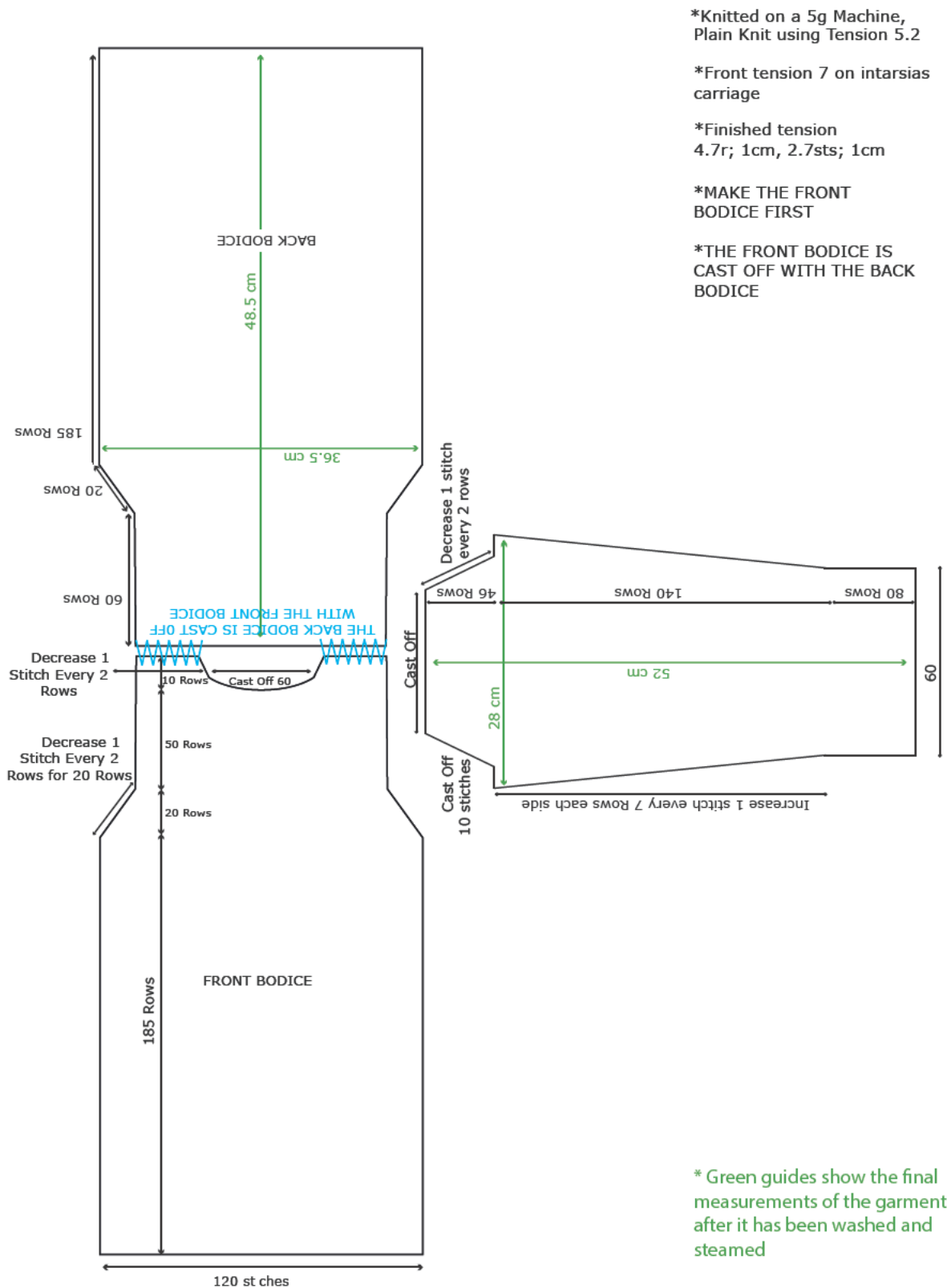


Fig 26

This is the pattern for the 'LOVE' sweater. This is a small size (8-10 UK). We used 1 end of 2/15's lambswool and we have washed and tumble-dried the finished sweater.



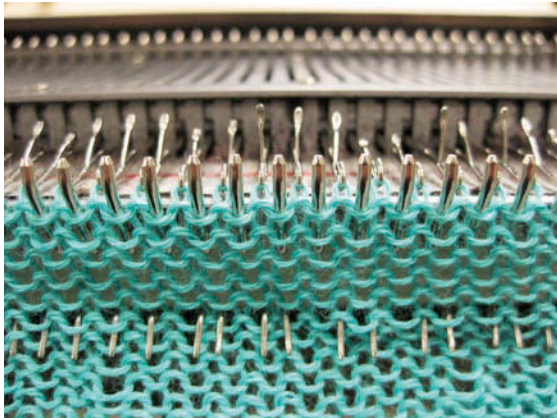


Fig 27



Fig 28



Fig 29



Fig 30

- Cast on 120sts with waste yarn. Knit about ten rows to hang the weights on. Knit the last row very loose (fig 27)

- e-wrap loosely each colour of the first line of intarsia according to the graph (fig 28)

- Push the needles back to D position manually (fig 29)

- Lay the appropriate colours across the needles, remembering to 'cross' the colours as they meet (fig 30)

- Take the intarsia carriage across from right to left

- Carry on twisting the yarns line by line following the graph (fig 31).

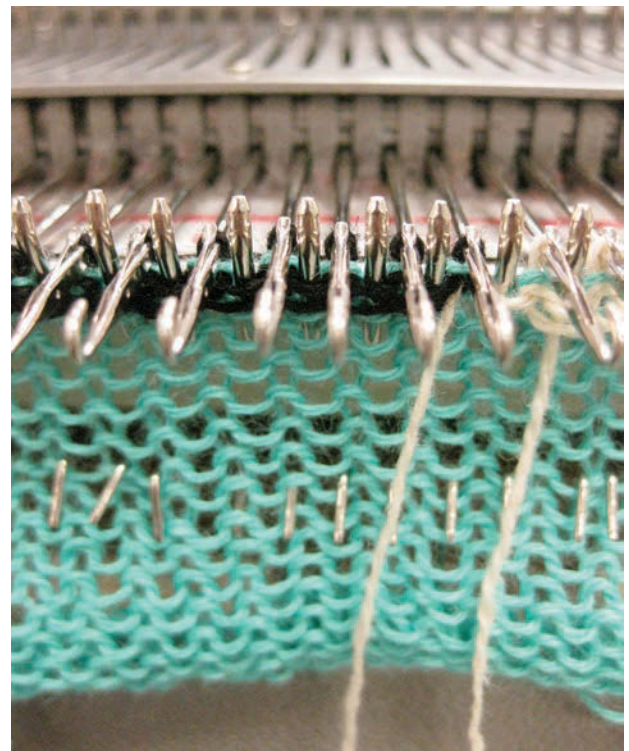


Fig 31



Fig 32a



Fig 32b

- This shows the progress of the intarsia. It shows the waste yarn (in jade) at the hem of the piece (fig 32a-b)
- You can see the yarns on the floor to feed onto the needles for each row.



Fig 33



Fig 34



Fig 35



Fig 36

- There is a good trick if you make a minor mistake with intarsia. You can 'swiss darn' over a specific stitch.

- So you can see in fig 33 there is a black stitch in the wrong place.

- Fig 34 shows the sewing needle threaded with ecru lambswool.

- Exactly follow the shape of the stitch with the needle and thread starting by bringing the needle from the back to the front of the base of the stitch.

- Bring the needle through the top of the stitch to the front again before going back through the base (fig 35-36).

- You will have formed a V shape with the ecru yarn covering the black stitch (fig 37).

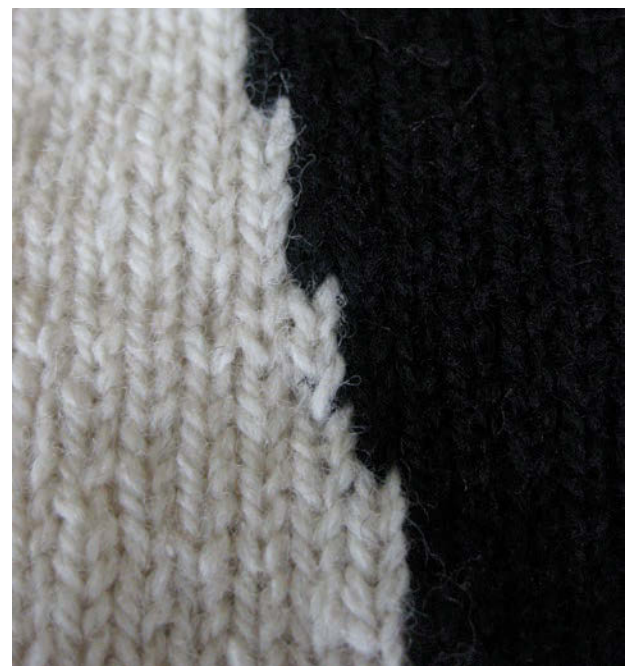


Fig 37



LOVE sweater - Hand knit

This is the graph (fig 38) to make the hand knit version. The graph paper was created according to the tension swatch. The tension ratio is 2.8r x 1,75sts /cm². When knitting by hand you follow the graph from the front of the fabric, on the machine you always follow the reverse side.

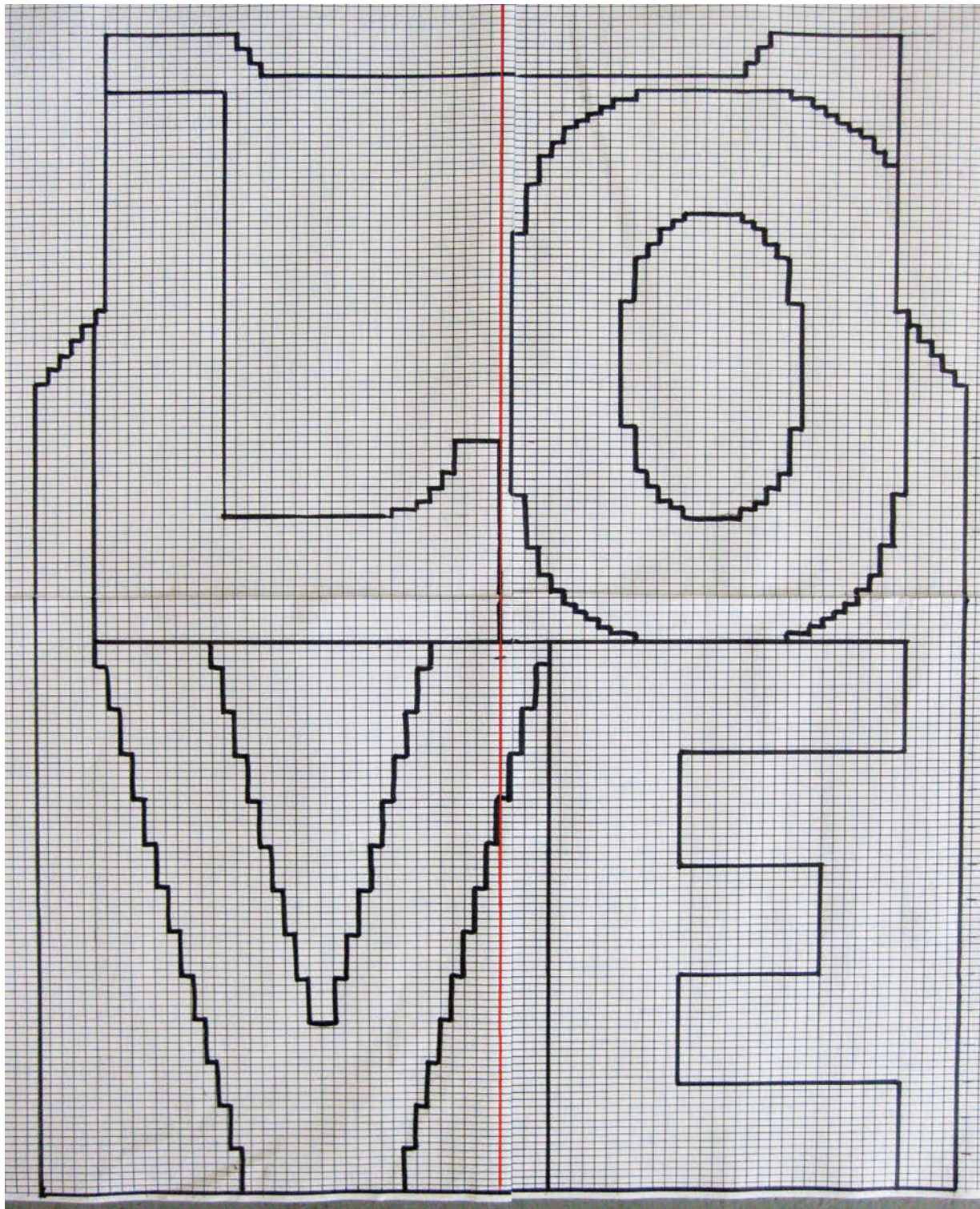


Fig 38



Fig 39



Fig 40



Fig 41

- Start by making a tension swatch (fig 39) using different size needles to find the right weight and thickness to your garment. Remember to steam and wash your swatch before deciding on the tension.

- Cast on a loose row following the first line of your graph.

- Remember to twist the yarn (fig 40-41) as you change colour on the first row leaving the loose end hanging free.

- You should have a separate ball of yarn for each section of colour on each line, exactly as knitting intarsia on the machine.



Fig 42



Fig 43

- Continue following your graph with knit one purl one to make plain knit.
- Always twist the yarn on the back side (fig 42-43) of the fabric to tie the colours together. If you fail to twist the yarn, you will end up with separate pieces of fabric.



Fig 44

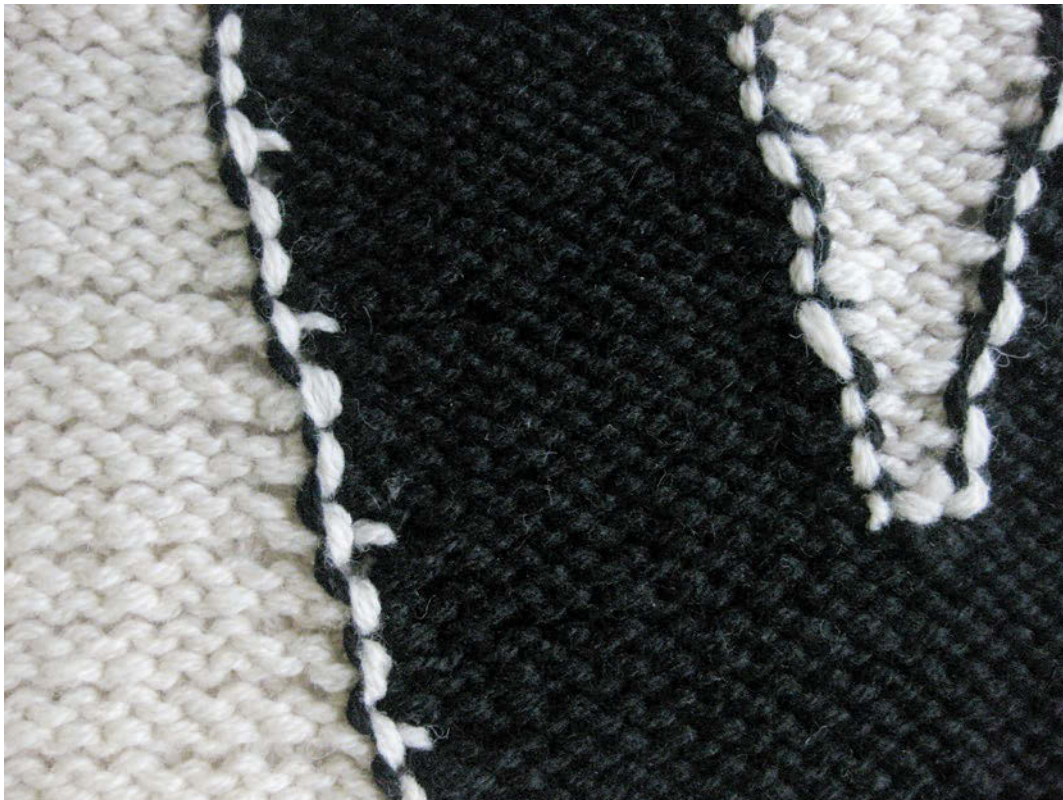
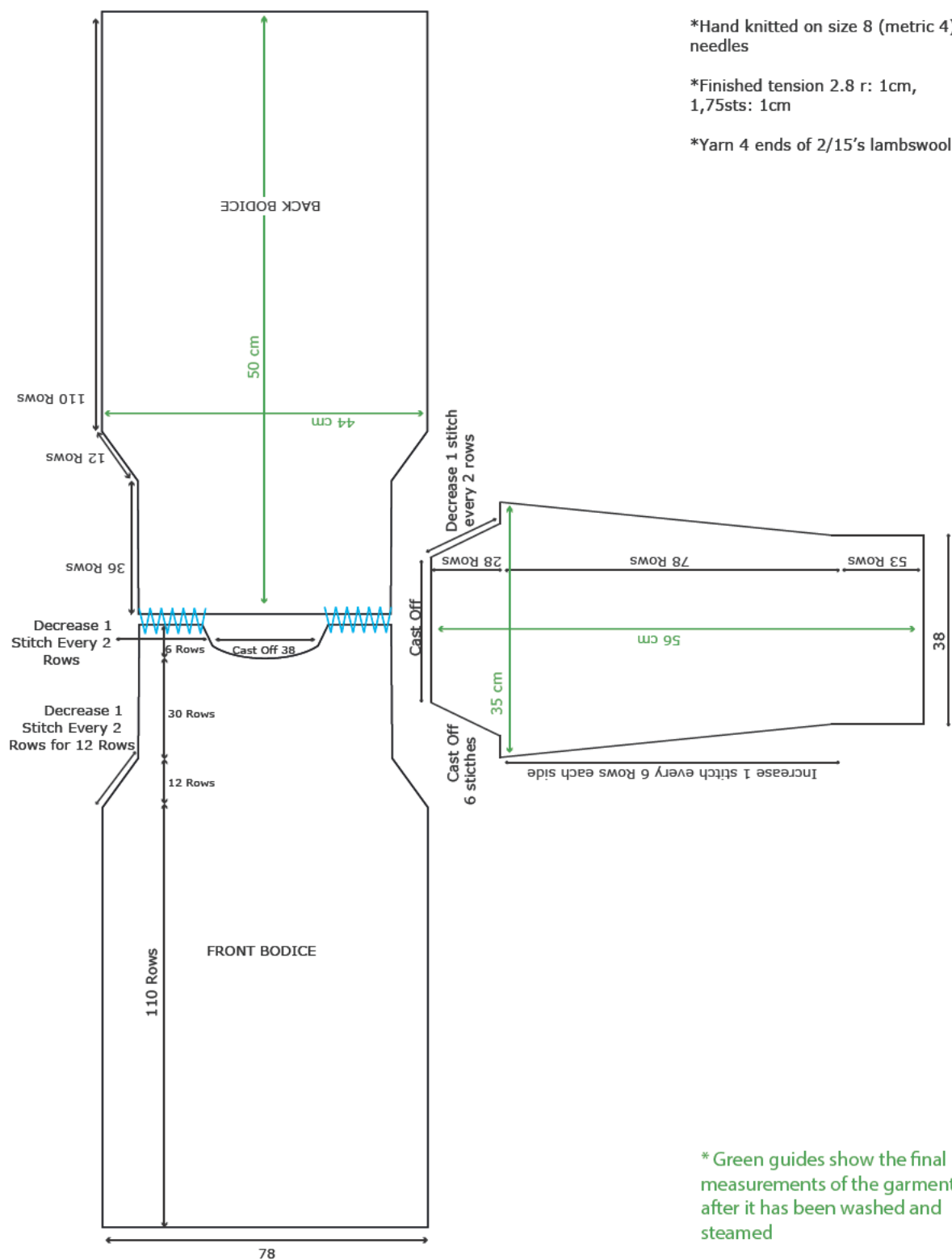


Fig 45

Twisting the yarn always on the back of the fabric creates a clean motif (fig 44).

This is the pattern for the hand knit version of the love sweater in a medium size. It uses exactly the same motifs and placement as the machine knit sweater. The yarn is 4 ends of 2/15's lambswool and knitted on size 8 (metric size 4) needles.



Floral



Intarsia is a great technique for knitting florals of all styles. You can interpret your reference in a realistic way or totally abstracted. For more intricate designs you can add to the design by hand-embroidering details such as the central stamens.

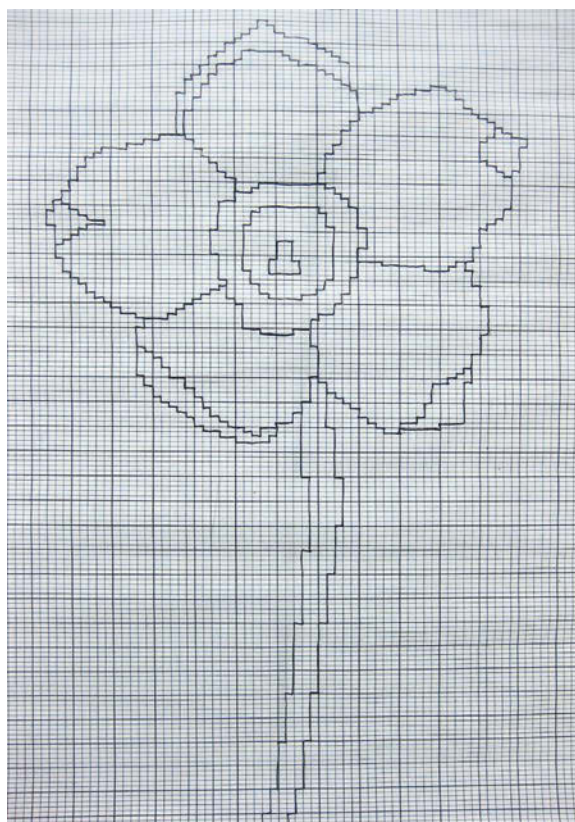
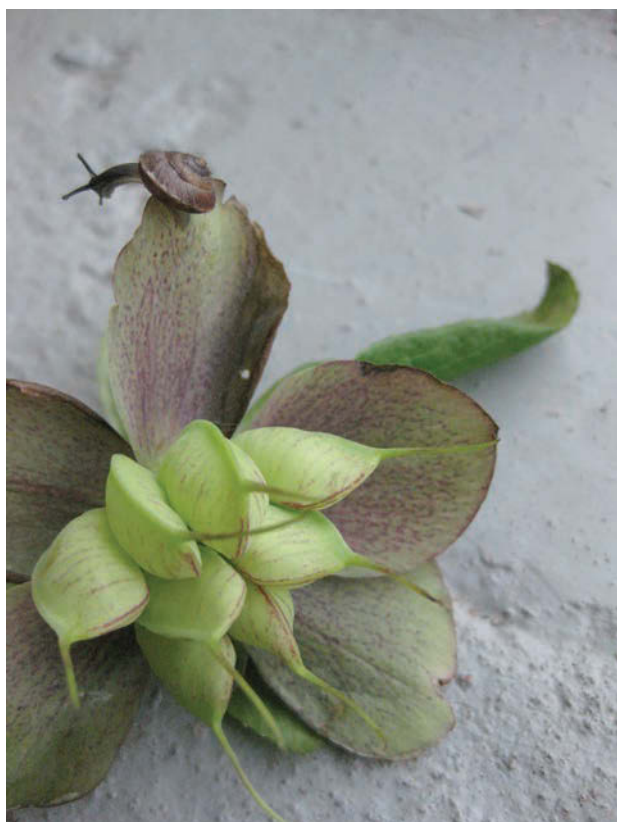
Inspiration can be directly from nature, photography, art or traditional needlework skills such as needlepoint.



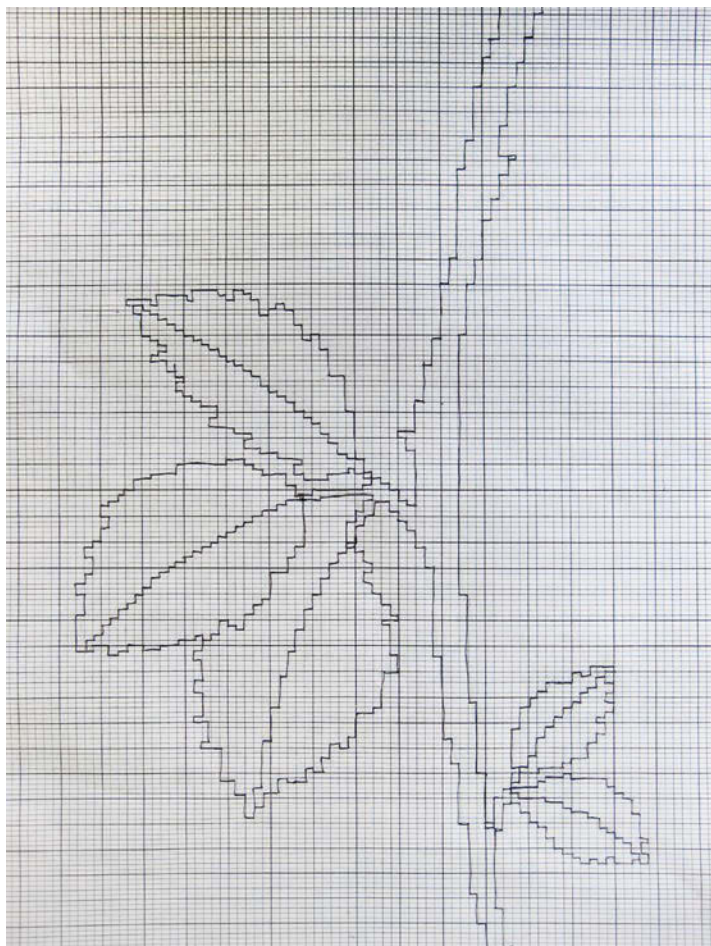


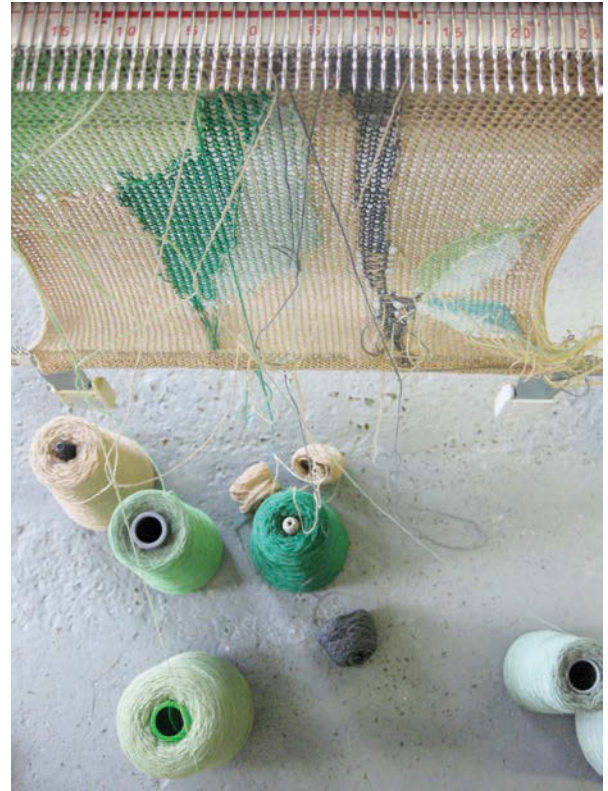
Hellebore

I used a real flower to make a simplified drawing, but keeping true to the strange colours of the petals. I translated my drawing onto the 5g graph paper and arranged the yarn colours to make sure they would harmonize. The final intarsia was enhanced with hand embroidery for the stamens.



Leaves



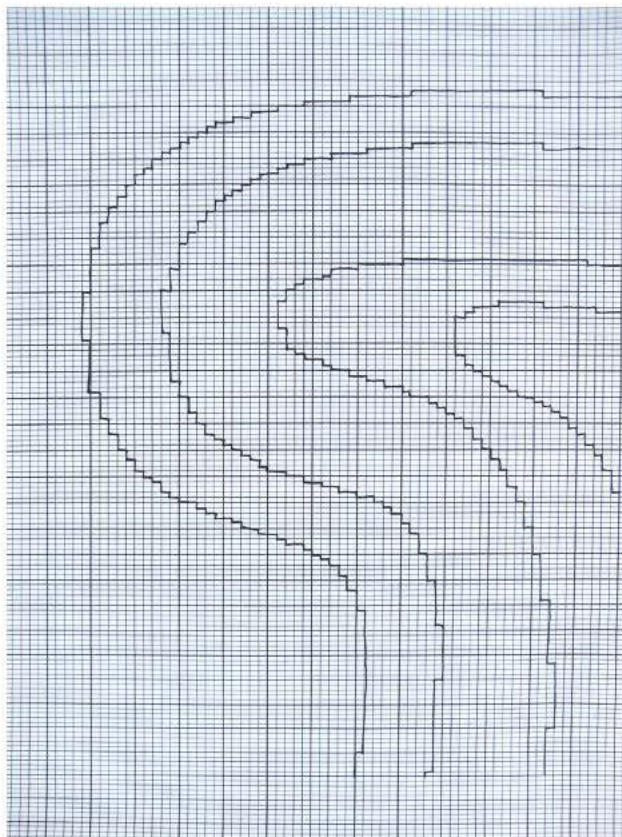
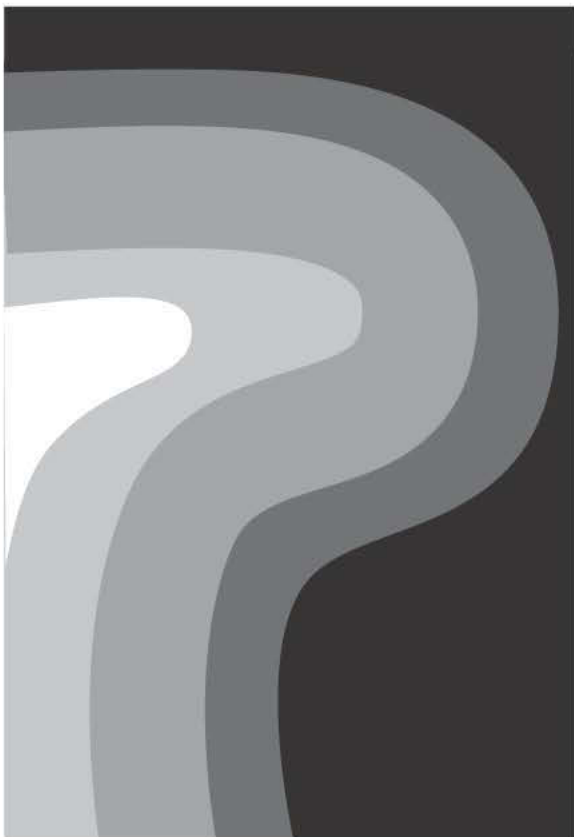


Abstract



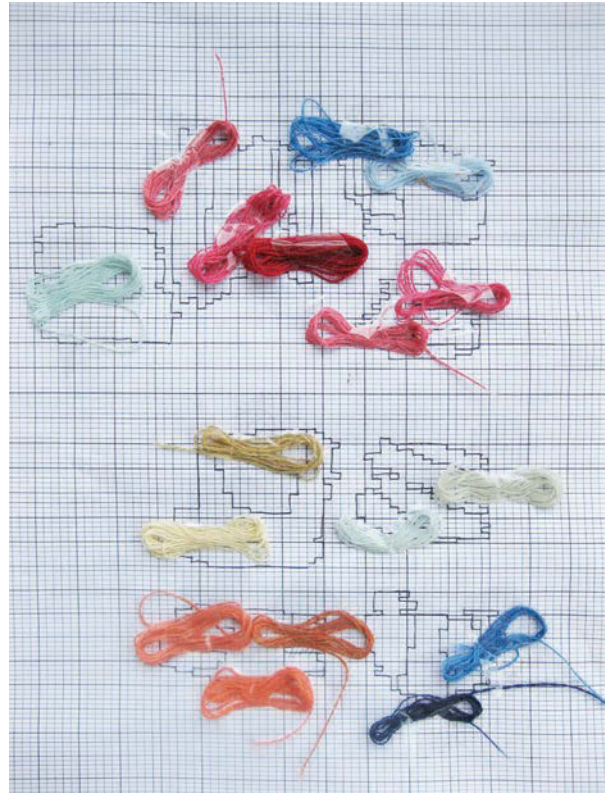
Abstract shapes work well either as strict, symmetrical shapes or asymetric placements. Shading tones of one colour can produce a very strong look. Modern art can be a great source of inspiration and works well for menswear.

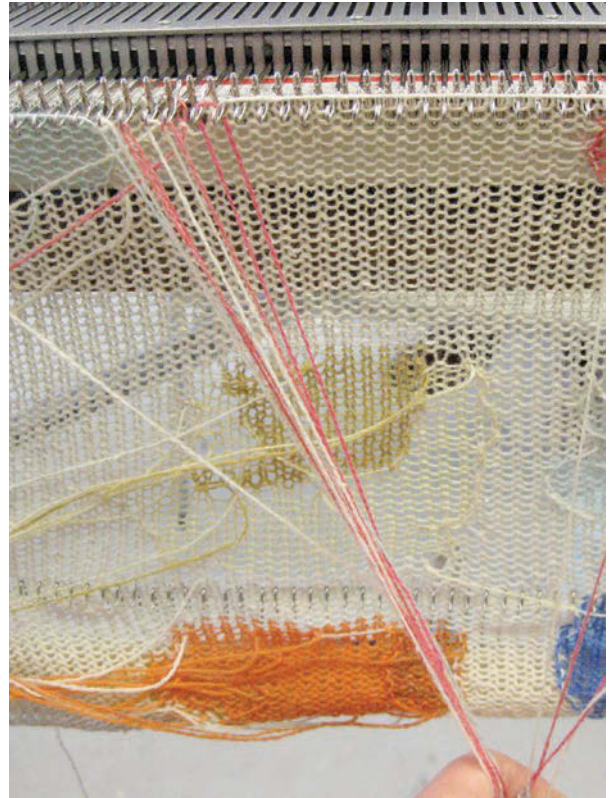
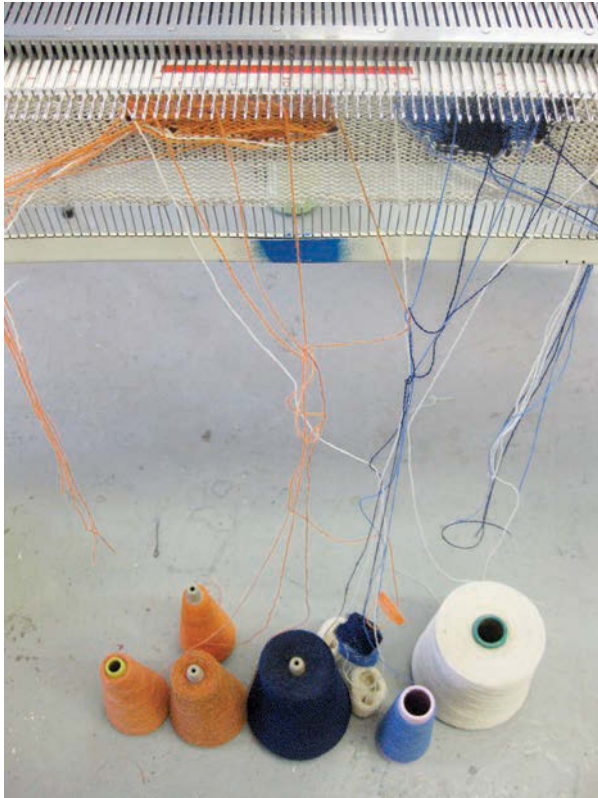






Paintbox





Colour blocks





Tone on Tone



A completely different way to approach intarsia is to consider the composition in terms of texture rather than colour. These are ideas using contrasting yarn surfaces in geometric layouts but with subtle, tonal colour selections.





Useful Information

cast off	bind off
e-wrap	Cast on method for finished edge loop yarn around needles from left to right making the shape of a lower case e around each needle while needles are in E position
needle positions	A non working position / needles will not knit B working position / needles will knit D <i>BROTHER</i> C <i>KNITMASTER</i> selected for pattern knitting/intarsia needles will knit E <i>BROTHER</i> D <i>KNITMASTER</i> holding position / needles will knit unless holding cam is switched to H or II position
r	rows (abbreviation)
sts	stitches (abbreviation)
swatch	piece of knitting / fabric

‘Bulldog’ and ‘Poodle’ designs on pages 16-17 by Lisa Landsburgh

lisalandsburgh@msn.com / www.cashmeretots.co.uk

T 44 (0) 7719 814885

Published by FASHION TEXTILE PUBLISHING
For more copies of this book, please email: orders@knit-1.com

Our Profile



Richard Dykes and Sue Enticknap have created and sold fashion since 1983 becoming established as one of the top fashion textile design companies, designing and selling to the industry at all levels of the market.

For over 3 decades we have designed and made our copyrighted one-off creative designs. We have an extensive range of customers and hence we are constantly working with the fashion industry worldwide.

As directors of Knit-1 Ltd we are dedicated to supplying our customers with ever changing, beautiful and original fashion textiles incorporating the best quality of design, make and finish.

It is this degree of professional expertise that has enabled the company to uniquely offer a wide range of intensive machine knit, embroidery and print courses taken at our premises as design workshops, also offering downloads and books available online and in selected bookstores. See our dedicated website (www.knitdesigncourses.com). Furthermore we have developed download courses available at our shop and fully translated at our newly created German language website (www.strickdesignkurse.de).

**Machine Knit by
Sue Enticknap and Richard Dykes**

**www.knit-1.com
www.knitdesigncourses.com**

ISBN 978-1-908839-17-6